

Seven visual directions for the staff portal — which one would you trust with a chart?

This is a rebuild of the portal that front-desk staff, clinicians, schedulers and records clerks use. Patients never log into it. Everything below shows the **same screen** seven different ways: the patient identity strip, an allergy banner, a records-request queue, and one form field. Only the colour, type and spacing change.

WHAT I'D LIKE YOUR READ ON

1. Does the allergy banner read as urgent — without becoming noise?

It's the one red thing on the screen by design. Too quiet is dangerous; too loud and it gets tuned out by 10am.

2. Can you decide from the status column at a glance, without reading it?

This is the one that changed since you last saw the page: status is now a chip with a shape in it, not coloured words. Judge whether you can spot every Pending in a queue at arm's length — and whether the colours match what you'd expect, and whether “Not answered” reads as different from “declined”, which are genuinely different things in records work.

3. Row height: which would you actually want on a shared workstation?

Use the Dense / Comfortable switch below. Dense fits about 8 rows where Comfortable fits 6. Dense sees more at once; Comfortable is harder to misclick.

4. Is name + date of birth + MRN the right set, in that order, to confirm you're on the right patient?

It stays pinned at the top of every screen. If you'd reorder it or want something else in it, that's useful to know now.

5. Which of these looks like a clinical tool, and which looks like a marketing site?

Blunt answers welcome. Direction G is dark — worth saying whether you'd ever want that in an exam room.

On a phone, judge the colour, type and urgency — not the layout. These are desktop screens shrunk down; on a real workstation they're about three times this wide. The queue tables slide sideways with a finger. All the patient details are invented test data.

THE BRAND COLOUR ALREADY EXISTS



primary
#0f7c91



primary dark
#0a5d6e

nav #103b46 **tint** #e3f1f4

Riverbend's teal is inherited from the portal that's live today, where it's commented "calm medical teal/blue". All seven directions are built from these values rather than replacing them — what differs is how much work the teal is asked to do.

THESE SWITCHES CHANGE EVERY SPECIMEN AT ONCE

Dense · 32px rows

Comfortable · 44px rows

Status as chips

Status as plain text · previous

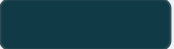
Status was coloured text before — one weak signal doing all the work. Now the three states are deliberately **unequal**, so the column has one thing to look for instead of three: **Pending is a solid block** of the attention colour because it is the only one that needs a person, **Released is a quiet tint**, and **Not answered is a dashed outline** because nothing has come back yet. Each also carries a shape — ● pending, ✓ released, ○ not answered — which survives greyscale and every form of colour blindness. Flip between the two and say whether the chips earn their weight.

A · Brand-faithful, corrected

CLOSEST TO TODAY

The colours the portal already uses, kept as they are — with only the ones that fail a legibility check raised until they pass, plus proper alignment on numbers and a visible focus ring.

Cost: it looks like the portal that already exists, so a rebuild behind it is invisible.

		
bg #eef2f5	surface #ffffff	text #1f2d36 12.5:1 AAA
		
muted #54636e 5.5:1 AA	accent #0f7c91 4.9:1 AA	nav #103b46 12.1:1 AAA
		
ok #276b47 6.4:1 AA	warn #8a5c00 5.8:1 AA	alert #b02a1c 6.6:1 AA

THE SCREEN — IDENTITY STRIP, ALLERGY WARNING, RECORDS QUEUE

Riverbend

Front desk

frontdesk ▾

Okonkwo, Mariam DOB 1974-03-02 · 52y

MRN 004821

⚠ Allergy — Penicillin (severe)

Immunisations unavailable for this patient — said plainly, not left blank

REQUEST	SCOPE	RECEIVED	STATUS
ROI-1043	full chart	2026-07-27 09:14	Pending
ROI-1041	labs only	2026-07-26 16:02	✓ Released
ROI-1039	imaging	2026-07-26 11:47	○ Not answered
ROI-1036	full chart	2026-07-25 14:20	Pending
ROI-1034	labs only	2026-07-25 10:05	✓ Released
ROI-1031	imaging	2026-07-24 15:41	✓ Released
ROI-1029	full chart	2026-07-24 08:58	○ Not answered
ROI-1027	labs only	2026-07-23 13:12	Pending

MEASURED CONTRAST OF EACH CHIP'S TEXT ON WHAT IT SITS ON

Pending

7.4:1 AAA

✓

Released

7.5:1 AAA

○

Not answered

TEXT SIZES

Page title

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Card heading

Body — patient name, main values

Secondary — table cells, hints

LABELS AND COLUMN HEADS

MRN 004821 · 1974-03-02 · 09:14

A FORM FIELD, AND WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE WHEN THINGS GO WRONG

DATE OF BIRTH

1974-03-02

while you're typing in it

that date isn't valid

Register patient

Cancel

Disabled

B · Deep-teal frame, white canvas

BRAND AS STRUCTURE

The dark teal stops being a sidebar tint and becomes the frame around a white working area. The patient identity strip sits inside that frame, so who you're looking at reads as part of the window rather than as another row of content.

Cost: a heavy frame eats vertical space — on a small laptop the queue loses about a row to it.

bg

#f4f7f8

frame

#103b46

12.1:1 AAA

text

#14252c

14.7:1 AAA

muted

#4e6169

6.0:1 AA

accent

#0a5d6e

7.5:1 AAA

tint

#e3f1f4

ok

#1f6142

7.4:1 AAA

warn

#845400

6.5:1 AA

alert

#a52418

7.3:1 AAA

THE SCREEN — IDENTITY STRIP, ALLERGY WARNING, RECORDS QUEUE

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ROI-1031	imaging	2026-07-24 15:41	✓ Released
ROI-1029	full chart	2026-07-24 08:58	○ Not answered
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MEASURED CONTRAST OF EACH CHIP'S TEXT ON WHAT IT SITS ON

Pending 7.5:1 AAA **✓ Released** 7.2:1 AAA
○ Not answered 9.8:1 AAA

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Register patient

Cancel

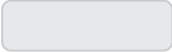
Disabled

C · Ink-first, teal rationed

TEAL = YOU CAN ACT ON IT

Almost no colour at all. Teal appears in exactly three places — the main button, whatever has keyboard focus, and the selected part of the menu — so anything teal on the screen is something you can act on, and nothing else competes with the patient's data.

Cost: rations the brand nearly out of existence. A screenshot of this reads as a generic tool, not as Riverbend.



bg

#ffffff

border

#e6e9ec

text

#0d1114

19.0:1 AAA

muted

#5a646d

6.0:1 AA

accent

#0f7c91

4.9:1 AA

ok

#2c6a4a

6.4:1 AA

warn

#7d5700

6.5:1 AA

alert

#a92a1d

6.9:1 AA

THE SCREEN — IDENTITY STRIP, ALLERGY WARNING, RECORDS QUEUE

Riverbend

Front desk

frontdesk ▾

Okonkwo, Mariam

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R0I-1027	labs only	2026-07-23 13:12	● Pending

MEASURED CONTRAST OF EACH CHIP'S TEXT ON WHAT IT SITS ON

● Pending

7.5:1 AAA

✓ Released

7.5:1 AAA

○ Not answered

11.0:1 AAA

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that date isn't valid

Register patient

Cancel

Disabled

D · Teal structure, amber for attention

TWO COLOURS, TWO JOBS

Teal holds the furniture together; a warm amber means “this needs someone” — a request still pending, coverage not yet verified, a consent nobody answered. Red is kept strictly for the allergy warning, so it never has to compete.

Cost: two accents means two chances to misuse one. Needs a written rule for amber versus red.

bg

#f5f7f8

frame

#0f4a58

9.8:1 AAA

text

#16242b

14.8:1 AAA

muted

#516169

6.0:1 AA

teal

#0f7c91

4.9:1 AA

amber

#9a5f06

5.2:1 AA

ok

#226b46

6.4:1 AA

alert

#a8241a

7.2:1 AAA

THE SCREEN — IDENTITY STRIP, ALLERGY WARNING, RECORDS QUEUE

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frontdesk ▾

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ROI-1034	labs only	2026-07-25 10:05	✓ Released
ROI-1031	imaging	2026-07-24 15:41	✓ Released
ROI-1029	full chart	2026-07-24 08:58	○ Not answered
ROI-1027	labs only	2026-07-23 13:12	● Pending

MEASURED CONTRAST OF EACH CHIP'S TEXT ON WHAT IT SITS ON

● Pending

7.3:1 AAA

✓ Released

7.5:1 AAA

○ Not answered

9.8:1 AAA

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Register patient

Cancel

Disabled

E • Maximum legibility

BUILT FOR A BAD MONITOR

For hour nine of a shift on a monitor nobody has calibrated since 2019. Every colour clears the strictest legibility standard, corners are square, borders are heavy, status and buttons are capitalised. Nothing here is decorative.

Cost: loud. Reads as industrial control panel, and "disabled" needs a signal other than colour because there is no grey background to fade into.

bg

#ffffff

border

#0d2b33

14.9:1 AAA

text

#000000

21.0:1 AAA

muted

#33434b

10.3:1 AAA

accent

#084956

10.0:1 AAA

ok

#0d5535

8.9:1 AAA

warn

#6b4700

8.3:1 AAA

alert

#8c1d13

9.1:1 AAA

THE SCREEN — IDENTITY STRIP, ALLERGY WARNING, RECORDS QUEUE

RIVERBEND

Front desk

frontdesk ▾

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ROI-1039	imaging	2026-07-26 11:47	○ NOT ANSWERED
ROI-1036	full chart	2026-07-25 14:20	● PENDING
ROI-1034	labs only	2026-07-25 10:05	✓ RELEASED
ROI-1031	imaging	2026-07-24 15:41	✓ RELEASED
ROI-1029	full chart	2026-07-24 08:58	○ NOT ANSWERED
ROI-1027	labs only	2026-07-23 13:12	● PENDING

MEASURED CONTRAST OF EACH CHIP'S TEXT ON WHAT IT SITS ON

● PENDING

8.3:1 AAA

✓ RELEASED

8.9:1 AAA

○ NOT ANSWERED

16.1:1 AAA

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while you're typing in it

that date isn't valid

REGISTER PATIENT

CANCEL

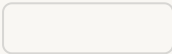
DISABLED

F · Warm and institutional

COMMUNITY CLINIC, NOT SAAS

Warm paper background and a serif for headings, so it reads as a community health centre rather than a software product — with the accent still taken from Riverbend's own teal, which sits naturally against warm paper.

Cost: the warm background lowers effective contrast in dense tables, so the serif is kept out of queue rows.

		
bg #f9f7f3	surface #ffffff	frame #123b44 12.1:1 AAA
		
text #1a1c1c 16.0:1 AAA	muted #635c52 6.2:1 AA	accent #0f6d80 6.0:1 AA
		
ok #1f6142 7.4:1 AAA	alert #a02a24 7.4:1 AAA	

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 Pending

7.4:1 AAA

 Released

7.2:1 AAA

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that date isn't valid

Register patient

Cancel

Disabled

G · Night shift

DARK ON PURPOSE

Dark as the normal state rather than an afterthought: the deep teal becomes the background and a brighter teal carries the buttons. The question this one asks is whether evening clinic hours and dim exam rooms deserve dark as the default.

Cost: worse for long reading and for printing, and most clinical rooms are brightly lit. Also the biggest departure from anything the client has seen.

bg #0d1e23	surface #132a31	text #e8f1f3 14.9:1 AAA
muted #9db4bb 7.9:1 AAA	accent #3fb6cf 7.2:1 AAA	ok #5fc98f 8.3:1 AAA
warn #e3b25f 8.8:1 AAA	alert #ff8a7a 7.5:1 AAA	

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ROI-1036	full chart	2026-07-25 14:20	Pending
ROI-1034	labs only	2026-07-25 10:05	✓ Released
ROI-1031	imaging	2026-07-24 15:41	✓ Released
ROI-1029	full chart	2026-07-24 08:58	○ Not answered
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MEASURED CONTRAST OF EACH CHIP'S TEXT ON WHAT IT SITS ON

Pending

9.8:1 AAA

✓

Released

7.1:1 AAA

○

Not answered

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while you're typing in it

that date isn't valid

Register patient

Cancel

Disabled

NOTES

- Real proposals:** colours, contrast ratios, type sizes, row heights, border weights, focus rings. Every contrast ratio on this page is calculated by the page itself, against that direction's own background.
- Not a proposal:** the arrangement of the screen. That was settled earlier and is reused here only so the colours sit on real content.
- Deliberately unfinished everywhere:** a dark counterpart for each palette, loading and empty states, and the wording review that makes sure no screen talks to staff as though they were the patient.
- Status chips are derived, not drawn:** every chip is built from that direction's own attention/success/neutral colour by one rule — Pending fills solid, Released tints the surface, Not answered stays unfilled — and then the text is darkened (lightened, on the dark direction) until it clears 7:1 against whatever it ends up sitting on, the zebra stripe included. The ratio printed under each queue is measured on the chip you're

looking at, so a direction can't pass by being described as passing.

- **Contrast floor:** body text at 7:1 or better, secondary text and accents at 4.5:1 or better. A red **FAIL** badge means that pairing can't ship as text — three colours in the current live portal fail it, which is a finding, not a rendering fault.
- Add `#only=A,B` to this page's address to see just two directions side by side.